

NEXORA TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

Employee & Company Policy Handbook

Industry: Software, AI, Cloud & IT Services

HQ: Kathmandu, Nepal

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Table of Contents

1. About the Company3

2. Working Hours & Attendance4

3. Remote & Hybrid Work5

4. Leave Policy6

5. Employee Benefits8

6. Code of Conduct9

7. Information Security10

8. AI & Software Usage11

9. Performance & Promotion12

10. Recruitment & Hiring13

11. Interview Policy14

12. Job Application Policy15

13. Grievance Policy16

14. Disciplinary Policy16

15. Expense & Travel17

16. Data Privacy17

17. IT Acceptable Use18

18. FAQs18

Policy Summary19

1. About the Company

Nexora Technologies Pvt. Ltd. is a Kathmandu-based technology company founded in 2018, employing 350+ professionals in software development, AI, cloud computing, and IT services. We serve domestic and international clients from our Lalitpur headquarters.

Mission: To empower organizations through innovative, reliable, ethically designed technology.

Vision: To become South Asia's most trusted technology partner by 2030.

Core Values: Integrity, Innovation, Collaboration, Accountability, Excellence, Respect.

Structure: Board → CEO → CTO/COO → VPs → Dept Heads → Managers → Individual Contributors.

2. Working Hours & Attendance

Standard Hours: 9:00 AM – 5:30 PM NPT (UTC+5:45), Sun–Fri. Lunch: 12:30–1:30 PM. Core hours: 10:00 AM – 4:00 PM. Minimum 7.5 productive hours/day.

Flexible Start: 8:00–10:00 AM, provided core hours are covered.

Late Arrival: After 9:15 AM is late. 1–3/month = reminder; 4–6 = written warning; 7+ = disciplinary review.

Early Departure: Unapproved early departure = 0.5 day annual leave deduction. Three/month = written warning.

Overtime: Pre-approved work beyond 7.5 hrs/day or 37.5 hrs/week. Weekday=1.5x, Saturday=2.0x, Holiday=2.5x. >4 hrs/day needs VP approval.

Public Holidays: All Nepal govt holidays observed: New Year (Jan 1), Prithvi Jayanti, Martyrs' Day, Democracy Day, Ghode Jatra, Nepali New Year, Labor Day (May 1), Buddha Jayanti, Republic Day, Constitution Day, Dashain (5 days), Tihar (3 days), Christmas (Dec 25). Dates published by mid-March.

Time Tracking: Daily Jira logs, 30-min granularity. Missing >2 days/week triggers reminder.

3. Remote & Hybrid Work Policy

Eligibility: 90-day probation complete; rating $\geq$ 'Meets Expectations'; role doesn't require physical presence; written manager + HR approval.

Hybrid Schedule: Min 3 days in-office (Sun, Mon, Wed). Max 2 days remote (Tue, Thu). Monday all-hands require physical presence.

Max Remote Days: 8 days/calendar month. Exceeding requires COO approval.

Availability: Reachable during core hours (10 AM–4 PM). Response time $\leq$ 30 min.

Equipment: Company laptop (i7, 16GB, 512GB), external monitor on request, ergonomic setup up to NPR 25,000, UPS provided. All remains company property.

Internet: Min 25 Mbps down / 10 Mbps up. Reimbursement NPR 2,000/month.

Outside Nepal: Max 5 consecutive business days without COO + HR approval.

Remote Denial: May be revoked for: 2 consecutive quarters below 'Meets Expectations', communication failures, security incidents, or business-critical on-site needs.

4. Leave Policy

Leave Type	Entitlement	Carry Forward	Approval By
Annual	18 days/yr (1.5/mo)	Up to 5 days	Manager + HR
Sick	12 days/yr (1/mo)	None	Manager (same day)
Emergency	3 days/yr	None	Manager + HR
Casual	6 days/yr (0.5/mo)	None	Manager
Bereavement	5 days (immediate family)	N/A	HR
Maternity	98 days (14 weeks)	N/A	HR + Medical
Paternity	15 days	N/A	HR
Unpaid	Up to 30 days/yr	N/A	Manager + HR + COO

Annual Leave: Submit 7 days in advance (single day) or 14 days (3+ days). Excess beyond 5 carried days forfeited Dec 31.

Sick Leave: Medical certificate required for >2 consecutive days. No carry forward.

Emergency Leave: Notify manager within 2 hours of shift start.

Casual Leave: 24-hour advance notice. Cannot combine with annual leave.

Bereavement: 5 days for spouse, child, parent, sibling, parent-in-law. 2 days for extended family (HR discretion).

Maternity: 98 days paid, contiguous. Medical certificate 30 days before start. Full salary maintained.

Paternity: 15 days within 30 days of birth/adoption. Birth certificate within 7 days of return.

Unpaid: 30-day advance notice. Health insurance continues 15 days. PF paused.

Approval Process: (1) Employee submits via HRMS, (2) Manager approves within 48 hrs, (3) HR finalizes within 24 hrs, (4) Confirmation sent, (5) VP approval needed for >7 days.

Unauthorized Absence: 1st=verbal warning+1 day deduction; 2nd (within 6 mo)=written warning+2 days; 3rd (within 12 mo)=disciplinary action; 5+/yr=termination grounds.

5. Employee Benefits

Health Insurance: Employee + up to 3 dependents. NPR 500,000/year inpatient/outpatient per member. Maternity NPR 75,000. Dental/vision NPR 15,000. Company pays 100% employee premium, 75% dependent. Enroll within 30 days or Nov 1–30.

Provident Fund: EPF 20% total (10% each), Gratuity 8.33% employer, Social Security 31% total. Full vesting after 5 years; 50% after 3 years.

Performance Bonus: Paid in March. Exceeds=up to 20%, Meets=up to 12%, Partial=up to 5%, Does Not Meet=0%.

Training Allowance: NPR 30,000/year for certifications, workshops, online learning. Reimbursed on completion proof.

Internet: NPR 2,000/month standard. Remote: additional NPR 1,000/month (receipts required).

Transport: Company shuttle, NPR 5,000/month fuel allowance, public transport reimbursement, late-night taxi up to NPR 1,500 (after 9 PM).

Wellness: Annual health check-up, 6 free EAP counseling sessions/year, monthly yoga, NPR 1,500 gym subsidy, team sports.

Salary Review: January, effective Feb 1. Increases 5%–15%. Not eligible during probation or PIP.

Promotion: Min 18 months in role (12 for exceptional). Two consecutive 'Meets Expectations' or higher. Competency assessment passed. Dept head + HR approval.

6. Code of Conduct

All employees, contractors, and representatives must uphold the highest standards of professional and ethical behavior at all times.

- **Professional Behavior:** Honor commitments, meet deadlines, communicate transparently, take responsibility.
- **Respectful Workplace:** No intimidation, humiliation, verbal abuse, threats, or social exclusion.
- **Anti-Harassment:** Sexual, racial, religious, gender-based harassment prohibited. Includes unwelcome contact, explicit comments, offensive images, unwanted advances, retaliation. Immediate disciplinary action up to termination.
- **Anti-Discrimination:** No discrimination in hiring, promotion, compensation, training, or termination based on race, caste, ethnicity, religion, gender, age, marital status, disability, or political affiliation.
- **Workplace Bullying:** Repeated mistreatment, abuse, threats, intimidation, humiliation, or sabotage. Report to HR immediately. Investigated within 10 business days.
- **Conflict of Interest:** Disclose within 7 days: competing employment, financial interest in competitor/supplier/client, using company resources for personal gain, supervising family members (needs COO approval).
- **Gifts:** Acceptable up to NPR 5,000/occasion and NPR 15,000/year per source. Excess must be declined or reported.
- **Communication:** No offensive, discriminatory, or confidential info via unauthorized channels. No personal mass emails from company accounts.
- **Social Media:** No confidential info, attacks on competitors/colleagues, or internal screenshots on public platforms. Use personal-opinion disclaimer.
- **Substance Abuse:** Illegal drugs and excessive alcohol prohibited on premises. Under influence = sent home + disciplinary action. EAP support available confidentially.

7. Information Security Policy

Protecting client data, source code, and confidential business information is a shared responsibility of every employee.

- **Passwords:** Min 14 chars, upper+lower+number+special, no name/username/common words, changed every 90 days, no reuse for 12 cycles. Bitwarden Enterprise mandatory.
- **MFA:** Mandatory for all systems. Primary: authenticator app. Backup: hardware key or secondary app. SMS MFA prohibited.
- **Devices:** Full-disk encryption (BitLocker/FileVault), EDR active, patches within 7 days, lock when unattended, no family use, return upon termination.

Classification	Description	Handling
Public	For public disclosure	No restrictions
Internal	General company info	Share internally only
Confidential	Sensitive business/client/employee data	Encryption + limited access + NDA
Restricted	Source code, financials, PII	Encryption + MFA + logged access + no external sharing

- **Customer Data:** Access only for role necessity. No downloads to personal devices. Anonymize for testing. Report breaches within 1 hour.
- **Access Control:** Least privilege. IT Service Desk request + manager + InfoSec approval. Quarterly review; unnecessary access revoked within 5 days.
- **Phishing:** Mandatory training within 30 days of joining and annually. Report suspicious emails to security@nexoratech.com. Never click unknown links or enter creds from email.
- **Software:** Approved list on internal wiki only. New requests evaluated within 5 business days.
- **BYOD:** Only if enrolled in MDM. Same encryption standards. No company data on personal cloud accounts.
- **Incident Reporting:** Report lost devices, breaches, phishing, unauthorized access immediately to security@nexoratech.com or 24/7 hotline. Good-faith reporters protected.

Level	Examples	Consequence
Minor	Weak password, delayed patch	Written warning + retraining
Moderate	Sharing creds, unapproved software	Written warning + 1–3 day suspension + retraining
Major	Data leak, unauthorized access	Up to 2-week suspension + PIP + legal review
Critical	Intentional theft, sabotage	Immediate termination + legal action

8. AI & Software Usage Policy

Approved AI Tools: GitHub Copilot, Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, Midjourney/DALL-E, Nexora Internal AI Platform. Others require CTO + InfoSec written approval.

Prohibited Uploads to Public AI: Source code, customer data, employee PII, financial projections, unreleased roadmaps, and any Confidential/Restricted data. Only enterprise versions with data protection agreements may be used for internal data.

- **Source Code:** Never paste into public AI assistants. Use only GitHub Copilot Business (enterprise account).
- **Generative AI for Work:** Allowed for drafting with human review, fact-checking, bias check, and client disclosure for external deliverables.
- **Human Review:** Marketing content → Marketing Lead. Technical docs → Senior Engineer. Legal/compliance → COO or legal counsel.
- **IP Ownership:** All work product using company resources, including AI-assisted work, is exclusive property of Nexora.
- **AI for Employment Decisions:** AI may assist resume screening, but all final decisions require human judgment. HR audits annually.
- **Responsible AI:** Fairness (test for bias), Transparency (inform clients), Privacy (comply with laws), Safety (test before production), Accountability (named human owner per system).

9. Performance & Promotion

Review Cycle: Biannual — Mid-Year (June) and Annual (December). Probation review at 90 days.

Dimension	Eng Weight	Non-Eng Weight
Technical Competency	35%	15%
Quality of Work	25%	25%
Goal Achievement	20%	30%
Collaboration	10%	15%
Initiative & Innovation	10%	15%

- **Goal Setting:** 3–5 SMART goals in HRMS by Jan 15. Mid-year adjustments permitted.
- **Promotion:** Min 18 months in role (12 for exceptional with VP approval). Two consecutive 'Meets Expectations' or higher. Competency assessment passed. Dept head + HR approval.
- **PIP:** 60–90 days for underperformance. Specific goals, weekly check-ins, training access. Failure = demotion, transfer, or termination.
- **Salary Review:** January, effective Feb 1. Increases 5%–15%. COO approves all >12%. Employees notified by Jan 25.
- **Feedback:** Annual 360° surveys, quarterly pulse surveys, open-door meetings, anonymous suggestion box.

10. Recruitment & Hiring Policy

Job Categories: Engineering, Product & Design, Data & Analytics, Sales & Marketing, Operations, Leadership.

Stage	Description	Duration	Responsible
1. Requisition	Manager submits JD + budget	2–3 days	Manager + HR
2. Sourcing	Posting, referrals, agencies	5–10 days	HR + Talent Acquisition
3. Screening	Resume review	3–5 days	HR
4. Tech Assessment	Coding test / case study	3–5 days	Hiring Manager
5. Tech Interview	In-depth technical discussion	45–60 min	Senior Engineer
6. HR Interview	Culture fit, salary, availability	30–45 min	HR Partner
7. Final Interview	Leadership review (senior roles)	30–45 min	VP / Director
8. Offer	Negotiation & letter	2–3 days	HR + Manager
9. Background Check	Education, employment, references	5–7 days	HR + Vendor
10. Onboarding	Contract, IT setup, orientation	1–2 days	HR + IT

- **Application:** Submit via careers.nexoratech.com. Resume PDF (max 3 pages), cover letter optional.
- **Resume Screening:** Within 5 business days. Criteria: qualifications, JD alignment, grammar, completeness.
- **Tech Assessment:** Coding challenge 60–90 min (HackerRank/Codility), system design (senior), case study (data), take-home 48 hrs (max 4 hrs effort).
- **Interview Stages by Level:** Junior = HR→Assessment→Tech→HR. Mid = +Panel. Senior = +System Design + Leadership. Leadership = Executive Search→CEO→Board→HR.
- **Communication Standards:** Acknowledgment 24 hrs; screening result 7 days; interview invite 48+ hrs before; post-interview feedback 5 days; offer/rejection 3 days after final interview.
- **Candidate Data:** Stored in ATS 24 months, then auto-deleted.
- **Offer:** Formal email with title, dept, manager, start date, compensation, probation (90 days), acceptance deadline (7 days). Extensions up to 3 days via HR.
- **Background Verification:** Education, last 2 employers, criminal check (sensitive roles), 2 references. 5–7 business days.
- **Rescheduling:** Once per stage with 24+ hrs notice. <24 hrs only for medical emergency (documentation) or technical failure. Second reschedule may disqualify.
- **Cancellation:** Nexora cancels = immediate notice + next slot within 5 days. Candidate cancels without reschedule within 48 hrs = withdrawn. Two+ cancellations = ineligible.

11. Interview Policy

Type	Duration	Format
HR Screen	20–30 min	Phone/video
Technical	45–60 min	Video or in-person
Panel	60–75 min	Video or in-person
System Design	60–90 min	Video + whiteboard
Leadership	45–60 min	Video or in-person
Final/Culture	30–45 min	Video or in-person

• **Types:** Structured (scored rubric), Behavioral (STAR method), Case Study (real-world problem), Panel (2–4 interviewers), Group (rare; graduate programs).

• **Identification:** Valid government photo ID required. Video interviews: ID displayed to camera at start. No ID = no interview.

• **Online Requirements:** Zoom (primary) or Teams (backup). Camera on, clear audio, quiet well-lit room, neutral background, stable internet (min 5 Mbps). No recording without written consent.

• **In-Person:** Arrive 10 min early. Business casual. Sign in, visitor badge, employee escort. No recording devices or unauthorized guests.

• **Acceptable Reschedule Reasons:** Medical emergency, death/serious illness of immediate family, unavoidable technical failure (with evidence), natural disaster, final exam conflict (with proof).

• **Reschedule Notice:** Minimum 24 hours. <24 hours requires HR approval and supporting documentation.

• **Candidate No-Show:** First = application on hold 14 days (may request reinstatement). Second = application permanently closed.

• **Interviewer No-Show:** HR assigns replacement or reschedules within 2 business days. Candidate gets apology + priority slot within 3 days.

Day	Available Slots (NPT)
Sun–Thu	9:30 AM – 12:00 PM, 1:30 PM – 4:30 PM
Friday	9:30 AM – 12:00 PM, 1:30 PM – 3:30 PM
Saturday	No interviews

Confirmation: Candidates must confirm 24+ hours before interview. Unconfirmed interviews may be cancelled. Confirmation must include: full name, date/time, contact number.

12. Job Application Policy

- **Who Can Apply:** Individuals meeting minimum qualifications. No nationality restriction if legally eligible to work in Nepal or as remote contractor. Internal candidates: after 12 months in current role.
- **Requirements:** Resume PDF (max 3 pages), valid email/phone, notice period/availability, expected salary (optional), all mandatory fields completed.
- **Required Info:** Full legal name, contact, education, employment history, skills/certifications, 2 professional references. False info = disqualification or post-hire termination.
- **Multiple Applications:** Max 3 open positions at any time.
- **Internal Candidates:** Priority consideration. Manager recommendation required. Not eligible if on PIP. Transition typically within 30 days.
- **Status:** Trackable via portal: Submitted, Under Review, Technical Assessment, Interview Scheduled, Interview Completed, Background Check, Offer Extended, Hired, Not Selected.
- **Withdrawal:** Anytime via portal or email. Cannot be reinstated.
- **Reapplication:** Not selected = after 6 months. Withdrawn (different role) = immediate. Withdrawn (same role) = after 3 months. Terminated = after 24 months (HR + COO approval).
- **Data Retention:** 24 months from submission, then deleted. Early deletion: privacy@nexoratech.com.

13. Employee Grievance Policy

- **Channels:** Direct Manager (routine), HR Business Partner (violations), Anonymous Hotline (24/7 online form), Ethics Committee (fraud/serious ethics: ethics@nexoratech.com), Open-Door with COO (monthly).
- **Level 1 (Informal):** Discuss with involved party or manager. Resolution within 5 business days.
- **Level 2 (Formal):** Written grievance to HR via Grievance Form. HR acknowledges within 2 business days.
- **Level 3 (Appeal):** Appeal to Ethics Committee within 7 business days. Decision is final.
- **Investigation:** HR initiates within 3 business days. Interviews, document review, dept head consultation. Completed within 15 business days (10-day extension possible with notice).
- **Confidentiality:** Strict. Identity disclosed only to investigation participants. Records kept 5 years.
- **Anti-Retaliation:** Retaliation (demotion, exclusion, threats, termination) prohibited. Retaliators face immediate disciplinary action up to termination.
- **Resolution:** Formal letter within 5 business days of investigation completion. Outcomes: mediation, disciplinary action, policy changes, compensation adjustment, or no action if unsubstantiated. Appeal within 7 business days.

14. Disciplinary Policy

- **Verbal Warning:** Minor infractions. Documented in HRMS within 2 days. Remains 6 months.
- **Written Warning:** Repeated minor infractions or moderate violations. Includes description, corrective actions, 30-day timeline, consequences. Employee must sign. Remains 12 months.
- **PIP:** 60–90 days for consistent underperformance. Specific goals, weekly check-ins, training. Failure = demotion, transfer, or termination.
- **Suspension:** Paid (during investigations) or Unpaid 3–14 days (confirmed major violations). Badge and laptop surrendered. System access revoked.
- **Termination:** Grounds: PIP failure, serious misconduct, repeated violations, gross negligence, redundancy. Notice: 1 day (probation), 30 days (<1 year), 90 days (≥1 year). Severance: 1 month base per completed year, max 12 months.
- **Serious Misconduct (Immediate Termination):** Theft/fraud, violence, sexual harassment/assault, intentional data breach/espionage/sabotage, under influence during safety-critical duties, falsification of credentials, unauthorized trade secret disclosure.
- **Appeal:** Within 7 business days to HR with specific decision, grounds, and evidence. Panel (HR + neutral dept head + dept rep) reviews within 10 business days. Decision is final.

15. Expense & Travel Policy

- **Business Travel:** Pre-approval from manager for travel outside Kathmandu Valley. International requires VP + Finance approval.
- **Transportation:** Economy flights domestic >300 km. Tourist train/bus shorter. Taxi/rental at destination (receipts required).
- **Accommodation:** Nepal up to NPR 4,000/night. India/South Asia up to USD 80/night. Other international up to USD 150/night. Book via company-approved partner when possible.
- **Meals:** Nepal NPR 1,500/day. International USD 60/day. No alcohol reimbursement without VP pre-approval.
- **Reimbursement:** Submit via expense portal within 15 days. Itemized receipts required for all >NPR 500.
- **Approval Tiers:** Up to NPR 10,000 = Manager. NPR 10,001–50,000 = Manager + HR. >NPR 50,000 = Manager + HR + COO.
- **Timeline:** Approved expenses reimbursed with next payroll (by 7th of following month).

16. Data Privacy Policy

- **Employee Data:** Name, contact, address, DOB, bank details, emergency contacts, performance data, health info (insurance). Used for payroll, benefits, legal compliance, emergencies.
- **Candidate Data:** Resume, contact details, interview notes, assessment results. Used solely for recruitment.
- **Collection:** Limited to necessary business purposes. Consent obtained where required by law.
- **Storage:** Encrypted company servers in Nepal. Candidate data in ATS. Daily backups.
- **Access:** HR, Finance (payroll only), IT (system admin only). Access logged and audited quarterly.
- **Retention:** Employee records 10 years after termination. Candidate records 24 months. Performance data 7 years.
- **Deletion:** Employees may request deletion of non-mandatory data. Legal retention requirements override requests.
- **Third-Party Sharing:** Payroll provider, insurance company, background check vendor, statutory authorities only. All under data protection agreements.

17. IT Acceptable Use Policy

- **Company Computers:** Business purposes only. No unapproved software. No removing security controls. Report loss/theft within 1 hour.
- **Email:** Business communications only. No spam, chain letters, or attachments >25MB without IT approval. No auto-forwarding to external addresses.
- **Internet:** Business use prioritized. Limited personal use permitted during breaks (banking, news). No streaming, gambling, or adult content.
- **Cloud Storage:** Approved: Company SharePoint, Azure Blob, AWS S3 (company account). Personal cloud accounts prohibited for company data.
- **Git:** Use only company-managed GitHub/GitLab. No pushing code to personal repos. All commits attributable to employee account.
- **Messaging:** Microsoft Teams and company Slack for work. No confidential info in personal WhatsApp/Signal for work.
- **Unauthorized Software:** No torrent clients, cracked software, crypto miners, or Tor without CISO approval.
- **Monitoring:** Nexora monitors systems for security and compliance. No expectation of privacy on company devices, networks, or accounts.

18. Frequently Asked Questions

Q1: How many annual leave days do employees receive?

A: 18 days per calendar year, accrued at 1.5 days per month.

Q2: Can I work remotely?

A: Yes, after 90-day probation, with 'Meets Expectations' rating, and manager + HR approval.

Q3: How many remote days am I allowed?

A: Maximum 2 days per week (8 days per month).

Q4: How do I request sick leave?

A: Submit via HRMS and notify manager same day. Medical certificate required for >2 consecutive days.

Q5: Can I reschedule my interview?

A: Yes, once per stage with 24+ hours notice.

Q6: What happens if I miss an interview?

A: First no-show = 14-day hold. Second = permanent closure.

Q7: Can I apply for multiple positions?

A: Yes, up to 3 open positions at any time.

Q8: How long does recruitment take?

A: Typically 3–5 weeks from application to offer.

Q9: What happens after the technical interview?

A: HR Interview for most roles. Senior roles may require Panel or Leadership Interview first.

Q10: Can I use ChatGPT for work?

A: Only ChatGPT Enterprise (company-licensed). Never upload confidential data to free/public versions.

Q11: What info cannot be uploaded to AI tools?

A: Source code, customer data, employee PII, financials, roadmaps, and any Confidential/Restricted data.

Q12: Who do I contact about a complaint?

A: Manager (routine), HR Partner (violations), Anonymous Hotline (24/7), or Ethics Committee (fraud).

Q13: How often are employees evaluated?

A: Biannually — Mid-Year (June) and Annual (December).

Q14: What is the probation period?

A: 90 days with a probation review at the end.

Q15: When are salary reviews?

A: January, effective February 1.

Q16: What is the overtime rate?

A: 1.5x weekday, 2.0x Saturday, 2.5x public holiday.

Q17: Can I carry forward sick leave?

A: No. Only annual leave carries forward (max 5 days).

Q18: What is the resignation notice period?

A: 30 days during probation; 90 days after probation.

Q19: How do I report a security incident?

A: Email security@nexoratech.com or call the 24/7 hotline immediately.

Q20: What internet speed is required for remote work?

A: Minimum 25 Mbps download and 10 Mbps upload.

Policy Summary

Policy Area	Key Rule / Number
Working Hours	9:00 AM – 5:30 PM, Sun–Fri
Core Hours	10:00 AM – 4:00 PM
Remote Days	Max 2 days/week (8/month)
Annual Leave	18 days/year
Sick Leave	12 days/year
Casual Leave	6 days/year
Maternity Leave	98 days paid
Paternity Leave	15 days paid
Health Insurance	NPR 500,000/year per member
Training Allowance	NPR 30,000/year
Internet Allowance	NPR 2,000/month
Max Bonus	Up to 20% of base salary
Salary Review	January, effective Feb 1
Probation	90 days
Password Length	Minimum 14 characters
MFA	Mandatory on all systems
Interview Reschedule	24 hours minimum notice
Candidate No-Show Limit	2 before permanent closure
Reapplication After Rejection	6 months
Candidate Data Retention	24 months
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This handbook supersedes all previous policy documents. All employees must acknowledge receipt upon joining and after each annual review.